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LG CX 4K Smart OLED TV

Is it still the best TV for gaming?

We first saw the 48-inch LG CX back at CES 2020.

While the LG CX is available in different sizes, it's the 48-inch variant that is marketed as a gaming monitor. Let's find out if it is still the penultimate small screen gaming TV.

BUILD AND DESIGN

Placed next to a C9, you wouldn't know which TV is which. It has a small tabletop stand that holds the TV in place from the centre when kept on a tabletop. It is relatively short, so don't expect to keep a set-top-box or gaming console below the TV. The tabletop stand is angular and looks premium.

The panel of the TV is extremely slim, with almost no bezels surrounding the display. It is slightly thick towards the bottom, where you have three HDMI ports and one USB port facing the side. Facing the back, we have one HDMI port, two USB ports, AV in, LAN, optical port, 3.5mm port and a good old antenna. Lastly, the LG CX comes with the same remote control we have seen on the GX, the C9, B9 and many more LG OLED TVs.

The CX has LG's Alpha 9 Gen 3 chips which LG showed off at CES 2020, and also comes with a Film-maker Mode that changes the settings of the content to represent the picture the way it was intended by the film-maker. Like the other LG OLEDs from 2020, the TV supports Dolby Vision, Dolby Atmos and HDR 10.

The LG GX came with far-field mics to let you control the TV by using your voice. Sadly, that feature isn't available in the CX. You have a



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mic button on the remote control that gives you voice controls, and you can long-press the Prime Video button to bring up Alexa if you like.

PERFORMANCE

With self-emitting back-lighting, we get an infinite contrast ratio on this TV and the colours on the OLED look deep as ever. When it comes to HDR performance, the TV is sublime. The peak brightness of the TV may not be as high as some LED TVs we reviewed last year like the Sony Z8H, but there is no halo effect or blooming when consuming content in pitch darkness thanks to the pixel level brightness control.

We consumed a lot of content from streaming services like Netflix, Prime Video and Apple TV in HDR and Dolby Vision, and the experience was nothing short of theatrical. The panel gets reflective in a well-lit room. But if you have curtains or the room's lighting isn't directly in front of the TV, you should be fine.

The only qualm we have is that the Disney+ Hotstar App on the LG App Store doesn't support Dolby Vision. Considering the vast library of content on offer on the platform, it's high time the app is updated.

FHD PERFORMANCE

When it comes to FHD and SDR performance, once again, you wouldn't know you are consuming FHD content if you didn't know what you are looking for. On the standard preset, the picture looks slightly muted and that isn't a bad thing. If you want

colours to pop, you can always switch to the Vivid mode. It's usually in such SDR content that we have seen Sony's OLEDs to produce better

colours, but unless you place the two TVs side by side, you wouldn't be able to tell the difference.

Overall, while some will worry about burn-in, if you vary the content you consume on this TV, it shouldn't be an issue. The TV offers some of the best performance we have seen, for SDR, HDR and even gaming.

AUDIO PERFORMANCE

The LG CX has a 2.2 Channel set up with 40W of sound output. The speakers on the TV support Dolby Atmos, but don't expect the sound to surround you from all angles.

You may miss some bass, but considering the clarity and volume level, the speakers are good enough to give an entry-level soundbar a run for its money.

VERDICT

If you are in the market for a premium TV then you can most definitely consider the LG CX. The only catch is the 55-inch variant of the TV can be found for close to ₹1,35,000. So, unless you are specifically looking for the 48-inch variant you should consider its larger sibling for a more cinematic experience.

—Sameer Mitha

SPECIFICATIONS

PANEL SIZE: 48-inch | PANEL TYPE: OLED | PANEL RESOLUTION: 3840 x 2160 - 4K | PANEL REFRESH RATE: 120 Hz | HDR 10 SUPPORT: Yes | DOLBY VISION SUPPORT: Yes | WEIGHT (WITH STAND): 14.4 kgs | HDMI PORTS: 4 | USB PORTS: 3 | BLUETOOTH: Yes (v5.0) | Wi-Fi: Yes | ETHERNET: Yes | SPEAKERS: 40 W (2.2 Ch)

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